

Studying at University in the UK: A Simple Guide

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Studying at University in the UK: A Simple Guide

Welcome everyone! This presentation explains:

- How UK universities work
- How to choose a university
- How UCAS applications work





Education Pathways

Universities: Institutions offering higher education degrees.

- **Public**: Funded by the government.
- **Private**: Independent institutions.

Further Education Colleges: Ideal for students who prefer hands-on, practical studies.

Apprenticeships: Combine work with education.

Learn more at:

<https://www.gov.uk/apply-apprenticeship>

What Is a University?

A university is a place to study after school.

- You usually study one main subject (called a **degree**).
- Most degrees take 3 years.
- Some degrees take 4 years (for example: with a placement year).





ENGLISH



GEOGRAPHY



CHEMISTRY



PHYSICS



HISTORY



ASTRONOMY



MATHEMATICS



BIOLOGY



LITERATURE

What Can You Study?

You choose one main subject.

- **Examples:**

- Business
- Engineering
- Computer Science
- Medicine
- Art & Design
- Law
- Foundation Diploma

In Scotland, it is possible to do joint honours, which allows some subject combinations. You do not usually study many subjects at the same time in England and Wales.

What Is A Foundation Diploma?

A foundation diploma is another option for students who would like an extra year between secondary school and beginning university.

- Some programs are one year long, and students apply for university again in the middle of their foundation year.
- Others are “integrated foundation year” programs, which are four years in length and include an extra year at the start of a standard degree.



Entry Requirements (What Universities Ask For)

Universities usually ask for:

- School qualifications (grades)
- English level (IELTS or similar)
- A personal statement
- A reference from a teacher
- Sometimes, a test (UCAT, LNAT, others)

Requirements are different at each university;
found at

<https://digital.ucas.com/coursedisplay/results/courses>





Entry Requirements (Examples)

Sample Course: [Business Management](#) at Cardiff University

- IB (31-34 overall, 665-666 in HLs)
- A-Levels (AAB-BBB)
- BTECH Extended Diploma in Business, DDD-DDM
- WJEC Level 3 Advanced
- The Advanced Skills Baccalaureate Wales will be accepted in lieu of one A Level and the A level grade specified

English Language Requirements

Most courses need IELTS or another English test.

- Typical requirement: IELTS 6.0–7.0
- Some universities offer English preparation courses. Do not worry – there are many support options.



How Much Does University Cost?

Overview:

- **Tuition fees for international students:**
 - Around £10,000–£35,000 per year
- **Living costs:**
 - Around £9,000–£15,000 per year

Some universities offer:

Scholarships

Fee reductions

Support for refugees



Support for Ukrainian Refugees

Many UK universities offer:

- **Scholarships for Ukrainian students**
- **Lower tuition fees**
- **Free English courses**
- **Mental health and wellbeing support**

Always check the university websites.



How to Research Universities

When choosing a university, think about:

- **Subject offered**
- **Entry requirements**
- **Location (city or small town)**
- **Cost and scholarships**
- **Student support**

There is no “best” university - it’s different for everyone.





Useful Websites for Research

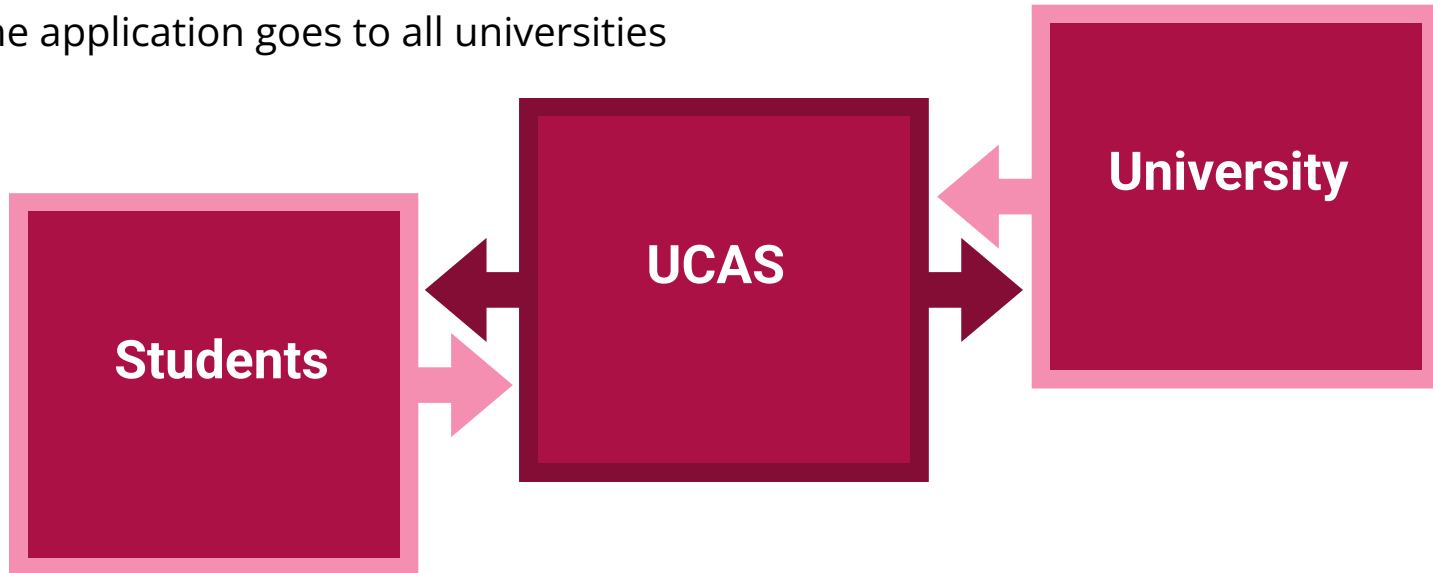
- **University websites**
- **UCAS website**
- **Rankings** (helpful, but not everything)
 - **Guardian League Tables**, by subject
- **Student reviews**

Take notes and compare universities.

What Is UCAS?

UCAS is the UK university application system.

- You apply online
- You can apply to up to 5 courses
- One application goes to all universities

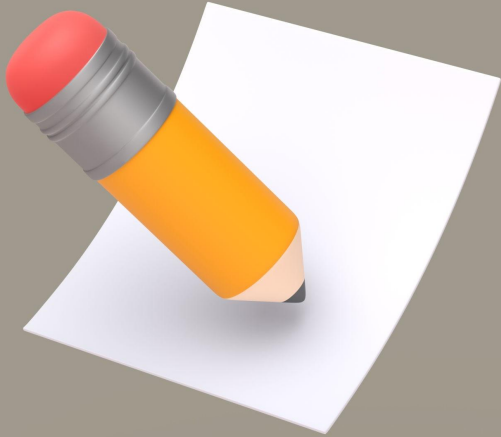


UCAS Application: What You Need

You need:

- **Personal details**
- **Education history**
- **Personal statement**
- **Reference** (teacher)
- **Course choices**

It takes time – start early.



Personal Statement (Very Important)

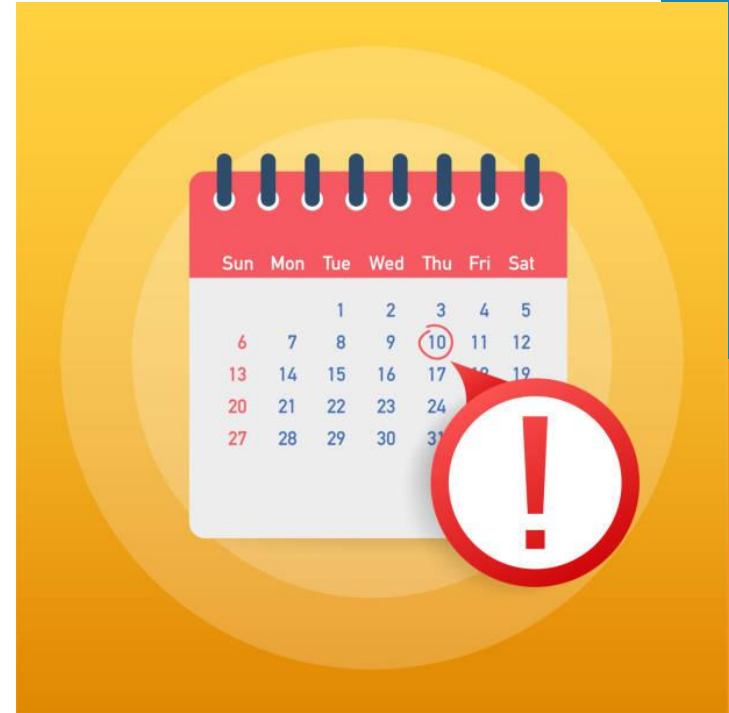


This is a 4000 character text about:

- Why you want this **subject**
- Your **skills** and **interests**
- Your **experience** (school, work, volunteering) It is not a **CV**.

UCAS Deadlines (Important!)

- Most **courses**: January
- **Medicine, Dentistry, Oxford, Cambridge**: October
- Some courses accept students later, but places may be limited.



After You Apply

Universities may:

- Make you an **offer**
- Ask for more **information**
- Invite you to an **interview**

Offers can be:

- Conditional (you must meet conditions)
- Unconditional (you already meet them)



Accepting an Offer

You choose:

- **Firm choice** (first choice)
- **Insurance choice** (backup)

UCAS will guide you step by step.





Key Advice

- Start early
- Ask for help
- Research carefully
- Believe in yourself

There are many people who want to support you.

Where to Get Help

- University admissions teams
- School counsellors
- UCAS website
- Refugee education charities



Questions

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